

STAINED GLASS

Written by

Lorenzo Besana

It's all just a matter of struggle between image and identity.

FADE IN:

INT. RIZZO'S - KITCHEN

Rigatoni are sauteed in a pan with gravy and some fresh cherry tomatoes.

An OLD MAN is handling the pan under the dim kitchen hood light.

The rigatoni are poured into two dishes. They have a homely look.

The old man throws the pan into the sink then picks up the two plates. We follow as he exits the kitchen. He's short, stocky and balding.

INT. RIZZO'S - DINING ROOM - CONTINUOUS

The cook exits the kitchen to an almost empty dining room. There are only two men sitting at a round table in the center of the small restaurant. They are talking softly and briskly, but shut up as they realize the cook is reaching them.

The two men are JOHN LEWIS a NEW YORK LAWYER in his mid to late forties and ANTONIO "TONY" DE LUCA, a man that's a little bit older. He's the head of the De Luca family.

TONY
(as the cooks places the dishes)
Grazie Gabriele.

JOHN
(to Gabriele)
Thank you.

GABRIELE
If that's all- I'll take off Tony.

TONY
Yes of course, just leave the keys to Donato as you leave.

GABRIELE
Good night Tony.
(to John)
Good night-

He hesitates to find the name.

JOHN
(offering his hand)
Thomas. Thomas Ford.

Gabriele shakes his hand.

GABRIELE
Well, gentlemen.

Tony nods and Gabriele excuses himself. As he exits the door we catch a glimpse of a tall, well-built man standing outside keeping guard of the restaurant

TONY
I didn't know I was having dinner
with a stylist.

JOHN
You can never be too careful Ton.

Tony starts vigorously eating the rigatoni. John doesn't touch his food.

TONY
You not hungry?

JOHN
I told you. I had dinner already,
also I better get going soon.

TONY
Your loss. Gabriele is best cook in
all of New Jersey. Since he was a
bimbo that guy has been cooking.
His ma', God bless her, you got no
idea how good a *parmigiana* his ma'
could make.

JOHN
I can imagine.

TONY
What's wrong with you?

JOHN
What do you mean?

TONY
You sit there all mopy, it's me
that should be worried Johnny, not
you.

JOHN
Your problems are my problems Ton.

TONY
(pointing his fork)
And I appreciate the sentiment, but
that's not entirely true. My *cazz'*
are my cazz'.

JOHN
Still. I'm trying to figure out the
best way to help.

TONY
Listen Johnny. It was a blow, I'm
not gonna lie to you, but I've
known those two kids since they
were born. I know their fathers, I
know their all families for
Christ's sake. They are not going
to talk.

JOHN
It's not talking I'm worried about.

TONY
You think they are gonna come back
like little rats?

JOHN
What if they do?

TONY
Let me worry about what if they do,
okay? You worry about what if they
talk.

JOHN
Yeah, okay.
(standing up)
I gotta go now Ton.

TONY
Sure. Give the wife my regards.

John smirks amicably.

JOHN
Will do.

The two shake hands and John heads for the door.

JOHN (CONT'D)
Tony also -

TONY
(without turning)
Yeah?

JOHN
If you see either of them around,
they flipped already. They'd
probably be wearing some kind of
wire.

TONY
You don't say.

JOHN
This task force Tony, they are
getting tired of eating what's
washed down to shore. They are
going to go whale hunting now.

TONY
Good night Johnny.

JOHN
See you next month Ton.

John exits and shakes hands with the man outside before
leaving.

Tony continues to eat as the wheels in his brain start
spinning.

INT. JOHN'S CAR - NIGHT - A LITTLE LATER

The radio is talking about the bust of an entire truck full
of contraband cigarettes that happened earlier that morning
in Brooklyn.

John drives calmly around the empty roads.

RADIO HOST
Assistant district attorney and
newly appointed head of the Anti-
Mob Task-Force Mary Rhodes says
quote: "We know this kind of
operation is just the tip of the
iceberg when it comes to mob-
related business, nonetheless we
can't underestimate the importance
of any result we can get".
Now the question for our panelist
is-

John shuts off the radio.

Soon after a call appears on the display, it's from a "B".

B

Honey?

JOHN

Hi B, how are you doing? I'm in the car.

B

Oh okay. Coming home?

JOHN

Yeah, I'm beat.

B

Same here. How was Chris?

JOHN

Alright, I guess.

B

Did you say hi from me?

JOHN

Of course. He sends his regards.

B

That's sweet. Listen, how far away are you?

JOHN

I don't know, I'd say about fifteen minutes.

B

I'm gonna go to bed then, is that all right?

JOHN

Yeah don't worry.

B

The kids are already in bed.

JOHN

Thank you.

B

Just please try not to be too loud when you come to bed. I had the longest day.

JOHN
I think I'll sleep downstairs
actually.

B
How come?

JOHN
Early call tomorrow.

B
I see. Well, goodnight then.

JOHN
Goodnight B.

B
Love you.

JOHN
Love you too.

B hangs up the phone and John makes a right.

EXT. JOHN'S HOUSE - NIGHT - LATER

It is a huge house in gated community. All houses look kind of the same. Clean streets, perfectly mowed lawns, white mansions.

John's car pulls up and parks in the driveway in front of the entrance.

John gets out of the car holding his briefcase and heads inside.

INT. JOHN'S HOUSE - LOBBY - CONTINUOUS

A tender beam of moonlight coming from the kitchen keeps the entire house from going completely dark.

John enters the house and proceeds towards the beam source without dropping his briefcase.

INT. JOHN'S HOUSE - KITCHEN - CONTINUOUS

John carefully rests the briefcase on the kitchen table and picks up a carved glass from the cupboard above it.

He slowly, tiredly walks to a cabinet near the sink from which he picks up a bottle of whiskey. He pours a little in the glass. Stops. Then pour some more, until the liquid has almost reached the middle of the glass.

Holding the glass he goes back for his briefcase then heads into the living room.

INT. JOHN'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - CONTINUOUS

With his sight impaired, John attentively ambles towards the couch, careful not to trip on anything.

He reaches the couch and sits but soon realizes he sat on the remote. He sighs then tries to lay his briefcase on the coffee table, but the darkness leads him to misjudge the distance between himself and the table.

The briefcase falls on the floor with a thump. John looks back hoping not to hear his wife awake.

She doesn't seem to have woken up, John takes the remote from under him and turns on the TV.

Some light, although barely enough to notice some details, is shed on the living room.

An old picture of John with his wife B hangs above the TV. John used to have his hair a little longer, sort of a 90's Di Caprio hairstyle, while we can't really see B's face we can see her long and thick blond hair.

A re-run of Seinfeld is on TV.

John takes a big sip out of his drink.

*KRAMER (O.C.)
What kind of person are you?*

*JERRY (O.C.)
I don't know!*

The audience laughs hysterically.

John lets his back fall on the couch and lays back his head.

The sounds coming from the TV start fading.

He closes his eyes...

INT. CAR - DAY

MARY RHODES sits in the back. She is in her late thirties, she has short black hair and the eyes of a determined woman.

She is the Assistant District Attorney for the County of New York and Head of the newly established Anti-Mob task-force.

As the car drives through lower Manhattan, she is examining some documents.

Her phone suddenly rings. She checks the caller ID then answers.

MARY
I'm almost there.

MALE VOCIE (O.S.)
Where the hell are you Mary?

MARY
I just passed Union Square, I'll be there in twenty minutes tops.

MALE VOCIE (O.S.)
They brought them in already.

MARY
What? Why?

MALE VOICE (O.S.)
How the fuck should I know?

MARY
Shit.
(to the driver)
I need you to hurry up as much as you possibly can.

The driver nods and speeds up a little.

MARY (CONT'D) (CONT'D)
(into the phone)
Okay listen - I need you to borrow me some time.

MALE VOICE (O.S.)
I'll try.

MARY
Thanks Bruce.

She hangs up the phone and bumps her fist on the seat next to her.

DRIVER
Everything okay miss?

MARY
Yeah just - hurry up okay?

DRIVER

Sure thing.

INT. DA'S OFFICE - MINUTES LATER

Mary comes rushing through the door, her assistant, RACHEL (20 ca.), is already right there holding some files and waiting for her. Rachel hands Mary the files as soon as she's inside.

They walk through the bullpen and towards the interrogation room. The bullpen radiates hectic masculine energy.

MARY

What the fuck happened? Why are they in already?

RACHEL

You know the guy.

MARY

Jesus Christ, really?

RACHEL

Yeah. He came in and went straight to Samuels. When he came out we were told to bring them up immediately.

MARY

I guess there's a silver lining to that.

RACHEL

Which is?

MARY

If they sent Richards for this two little shits, it means they are getting worried.

Rachel opens a door at the right end of the bullpen and they head the interrogation rooms corridor.

Mary enters while Rachel holds back.

Mary turns to her.

MARY (CONT'D)

Where's Richards?

RACHEL

In A with De Santis, Rocco is in C. Bruce is also in A already.

MARY

Good. Why is Rocco not B?

Rachel shrugs.

RACHEL

Do you need anything more from me?

MARY

Yes actually, when you have a moment I need you to call **John** and ask him if he can go pick up Grace from school - or send the nanny - or whatever. I don't think I'll make it.

RACHEL

Sure.

MARY

Thanks.

Rachel closes the door behind her and Mary heads for interrogation room A.

INT. INTERROGATION ROOM A - CONTINUOUS

Mary enters.

On one side of the interrogation table sit JOEY DE SANTIS (20's) with his lawyer MARK RICHARDS (50's) on his side. On the other is BRUCE CAMPBELL (late 50's), a seasoned detective with the NYPD.

MARY

Gentlemen.

Richards and Bruce stand up, De Santis doesn't even turn to face her.

RICHARDS

(shaking hands with Mary)

How you doing Mary?

MARY

It's actually Miss Rhodes, Richards.

RICHARDS

Oh come on, really?

MARY

Yeah, really.

(MORE)

MARY (CONT'D)
(to Bruce)
How are we doing Bruce?

BRUCE
Haven't talked that much.

MARY
I see.

Mary drops the files on the table and sits in front of De Santis, Bruce and Richards follow her lead.

MARY (CONT'D)
You are Joey, right?

De Santis doesn't answer.

BRUCE
He was instructed not to answer any leading question.

MARY
How was that leading?

RICHARDS
(imitating Mary's intonation)
Right?

Mary turns to Bruce. Bruce opens his arms as to say "What are you gonna do?".

MARY
I know what leading means, thank you.

RICHARDS
I was just clarifying our stance.

MARY
Our stance, right.
(to De Santis)
What's your name?

DE SANTIS
Joey. Joey De Santis.

MARY
Joey, do you understand what you are facing here?

DE SANTIS
I do.

MARY

Bruce would you be so kind to
remind the gentleman?

RICHARDS

There's really no need for that.

MARY

That's really not your call, is it?
Sorry, leading question.

(a beat)

Bruce, please.

BRUCE

Well, Mister De Santis here was
caught with a lot of illegal
cigarettes. Which, keep in mind,
wouldn't be that bad of an offense.
Something a lawyer with the
expertise of Mr. Richards could
easily get you out of with very
little jail time, if any. But. And
it's a big but. Firstly, you tried
to run from the police, and let me
tell you that really doesn't bode
well for you. Secondly there's your
record, which frankly it's quite
terrible. Not to mention the
possibility of a RICO.

RICHARDS

That's preposterous.

MARY

So, what are we talking about here
Bruce?

BRUCE

I could see a pretty strict judge
give him seven to ten years.
Something like that. Not to mention
the RICO.

DE SANTIS

For some cigarettes?!

RICHARDS

Joey.

DE SANTIS

Sorry.

MARY

What did he tell you?

RICHARDS

I told him the truth, which is clearly not what you are doing here.

MARY

Mister De Santis did you and mister Richards ever meet before today?

RICHARDS

(to Joey)

You don't have to answer that.

MARY

(to Bruce)

Do you think they ever met before?

BRUCE

Seems unlikely.

RICHARDS

Do you have any more questions or do you just want to keep on speculating?

MARY

Actually, I just want to say to mister De Santis, or better to remind mister De Santis, since I figure he's smart enough to have already figured this out on his own, he's not working in your best interest.

RICHARDS

I think we are done here.

MARY

I think so too.

Mary stands up and Bruce follows. They exit the room.

INT. CORRIDOR - CONTINUOUS

Bruce closes the door behind him.

BRUCE

What do you say?

MARY

I think we can get him.

BRUCE

He's scared.

MARY

Yeah. That's good. But we have to be careful.

BRUCE

Do you want to see Rocco right away?

MARY

He must have been prepped already as well.

BRUCE

Probably.

MARY

By the way, why is he not in B?

The door behind Bruce opens, Richards exits on the corridor.

RICHARDS

(to Mary)

What kind of game were you even playing in there?

MARY

What are you even talking about?

RICHARDS

Threatening my client with a RICO. You don't have the slightest evidence to build up a RICO.

MARY

Don't we?

BRUCE

I think you are the one speculating out here mister Richards.

RICHARDS

Sure. Okay.

(a beat)

How long before you start with the other guy?

MARY

What's his name?

RICHARDS

Very funny Mary.

MARY

Miss Rhodes.

BRUCE

We are good to go right away.

RICHARDS

Sure thing.

Richards heads for interrogation room C.

MARY

Tony's really making the best out
of your deal, isn't he?

Richards is about to open the door but stops and turns to
Mary.

RICHARDS

I don't understand what's the
implication here, *Miss Rhodes*. Care
to elaborate?

Mary smirks. Richards enters the room.

BRUCE

You know better than that Mary.

MARY

It's fine.

I/E. TOTINO'S DELICATESSEN - DAY

A black SUV parks next to the sidewalk right in front of the
delicatessen's entrance. TONY comes out of the car and walks
right into the place.

Different cuts of meat are displayed above the counter and
in the display cases, they are all referenced with their
Italian name.

There's a small queue, everybody greets him and Tony shakes
hands with everybody.

Once he reaches the counter, he passes behind it. The guy
working behind the counter stops talking to a client to
greet Tony. They hug and they share two kisses on the
cheeks.

TONY

Look at that *prosciutto*, *maronn'*.

GUY #1

Straight from the old country, can
I get you some Ton?

TONY
It's alright.
(holding his belly)
Trying to cut back, thanks though.
(a beat)
They back there?

GUY #1
I think so.

TONY
Okay. Take care. I'll see you
later.

GUY #1
See you Tony.
(to the customer)
So what can I get you?

Tony walks through the door behind the counter, into the storage room where the meat is cut before is ready to be sold.

A MAN in his thirties is sitting on a chair in front of a metal door. The door is behind a corner, so that you wouldn't notice it if you were looking from the counter.

The guy is smoking next to a small window. Once he sees Tony come in, he throws the cigarettes out the window and quickly stands up.

Tony gestures with his hand before his nose to signal he can smell the cigarette.

Tony walks up to the guy.

TONY
How many fucking times I gotta tell
you: YOU DON'T SMOKE IN HERE. You
fucking idiot.

GUY #2
I'm sorry Tony. I forget.

TONY
You forget. There's fucking food in
here.

GUY #2
Yeah I didn't think -

Tony slaps him right in the face.

TONY
Open the fucking door.

GUY #2
Sorry Tony.

The poor guy opens the door and Tony walks in.

The guy caresses his face as he closes the door behind Tony.

INT. BACK ROOM - CONTINUOUS

The back room is actually a small apartment in and on itself. There's a couple of couches and an armchair in front of a nice TV (*BICYCLE THIEVES* is playing on it with no volume), a small kitchen equipped with stoves and oven, a large fridge, a pool table, some books and magazines scattered around.

In particular, there's a table where four guys were playing cards before Tony came in.

They are Tony's inner circle.

There's GIACOMO "JACKIE" DIMARZO, about Tony's age, fat, balding, he's Tony's muscle.

LORENZO "SKINNY" TESTA, also about Tony's age, thin, thick dark hair, he's Tony's most trusted *consigliere* and also sort of the chief accountant of the all operation.

LUCA "CHIAVI (keys)" CARRETTA, he's older than the other guys, one of the few left from the previous generation. He takes great pride in keeping in shape and often wears tank tops to show-off his arms. He's got silver hair. He takes his nickname from his ability to find a solution for seemingly every situation. He's very practical.

Lastly there's ANTONIO "TONY BOY" DANTE. He's noticeably younger than the other guys, he dresses fashionably and doesn't look like he sleeps too much. He's Tony's best prospect, who has eyed him to one day be his successor.

They stand up to greet Tony.

TONY
It's okay.

JACKIE
So what's up T?

Tony walks to the kitchen to fix himself a drink.

TONY

They were with you Chiavi, right?

CHIAVI

Yeah.

TONY

Okay, let's make sure everybody chips in to cover the loss. Okay? It's no time to forget the importance of solidarity.

TONY BOY

What do you mean?

TONY

I met my friend last night and - well - this task-force it's not some "let's show the taxpayers we're doing something while we eat doughnuts in the city" bullshit. They actually want to get some shit done.

SKINNY

But I mean, it's not the first time they tried something like that.

TONY

I don't know. I don't like that broad. Let's make sure our foot is well planted in the ground.

CHIAVI

Sure T.

TONY

On that point. Skinny. Those two guys, they got family or something?

Tony comes over and takes a chair to join the table. He takes a bottle of whiskey with him.

SKINNY

The Rocco kid is by himself, De Santis got a little girl that's staying with his mother. No wife or girlfriend that I know of.

TONY

How old's daughter?

SKINNY

Twelve.

TONY

Chiavi?

CHIAVI

She'll be taken care of, you don't gotta worry about that.

SKINNY

Remember his father?

TONY BOY

Johnny De Santis, I remember him. He used to pick us up after practice in middle school. Joey was devastated when he dipped.

JACKIE

Yeah - he didn't really go anywhere.

TONY BOY

What?

JACKIE

Yeah.

TONY BOY

Oh shit. I had no idea. What happened?

TONY

It was a long time ago, it doesn't matter.

SKINNY

Remember his wife's name T?

TONY

Yeah. That was one huge load of shit.

TONY BOY

What's her name?

CHIAVI

She's O'Neil.

TONY BOY

So what?

SKINNY

So she's fucking Irish.

TONY BOY
I don't understand.

TONY
There's a lot you don't know kid,
you don't gotta worry about that
now.

SKINNY
Should I?

TONY
Yeah. Send my friend. Just to make
sure worse come to worse everything
is straightened out.

SKINNY
Sure.

TONY
All the rest?

Tony takes a card deck and starts shuffling.

TONY (CONT'D)
Business as usual.

CHIAVI
Actually T-

TONY
What?

JACKIE
Maybe - we don't know yet -
something came up with the race
truck.

TONY
(to Skinny)
Fuck they mean?

SKINNY
Little Jackie called this morning.
Light envelope.

Tony stops shuffling.

TONY
How much?

TONY BOY
It wasn't that much.

TONY
You shut up. How much?

SKINNY
Couple of Gs.

Tony throws away the deck and stands up irate.

TONY
ON THE SECOND FUCKING MONTH?!

SKINNY
it's not that much T.

TONY
It's unacceptable that's what it
is.

He turns and points to Tony Boy.

TONY (CONT'D)
You drive Jackie down there right
now.

Tony points to Jackie.

TONY (CONT'D)
You go with Tony Boy and make
fucking sure this never happens
again. Okay?

TONY BOY
Sure - Let's go.

BIG JACKIE
Of course T.

Tony Boy and Jackie leave from a backdoor. Tony sits back
down, trying to calm down.

SKINNY
You shouldn't get agitated like
that T.

CHIAVI
It's not good for you heart to get
all worked up.

TONY
Oh go fuck yourself.

Tony leans back and takes a big breath before filling up his
glass again. He fills up those of the other two as well.

TONY, CHIAVI, SKINNY
Salud!

Tony takes a big sip before leaning back again.

TONY
 (to Skinny)
 Make sure that my friend goes to
 see O'Neil as soon as possible.

INT. JOHN'S OFFICE - DAY

John works from a spacious office at a high floor of a
 skyscraper on Madison Avenue in New York. It is a corner
 office with two window walls that allow him to watch over
 the city.

John sits behind the desk working on his lap top.

His landline rings and he presses a button.

JOHN
 Yes Tracy?

TRACY (O.S.)
 Mister Lewis your lunch is here.

JOHN
 I didn't order any lunch.

TRACY (O.S.)
 Do you want me to send him away?

JOHN
 Wait. Where his he from?

TRACY (O.S.)
 (to the delivery guy)
 Where are you from?
 (a beat)
 He says he's from a-
 (to the guy)
 Rizzo's you said?
 (to John)
 He's from Rizzo's.

JOHN
 Oh yeah. I got caught up and forgot
 I called them. Send him through.

TRACY (O.S.)
 Sure thing Mister Lewis.

JOHN
Thank you Tracy.

John closes his laptop and goes to stand at the window. He looks a little worried, this is not how this kind of things usually happen.

After a short while there's a knock on the door.

JOHN (CONT'D)
Come in.

The door opens and TRACY appears from behind it. She's blonde, in her TWENTIES, she's wearing loose jeans with a white shirt tucked in them. She's holding a rectangular carton box with RIZZO'S written on.

JOHN (CONT'D)
Where's the guy?

TRACY
He said he didn't want to bother
and asked if I could bring it in. I
said it was no trouble at all.

JOHN
How much do I owe you?

TRACY
He said they put in on your tab?
Something of that nature. I tried
to tip him at least but he said he
didn't want to be tipped.

JOHN
I guess he must work for the only
restaurant in all of the US that
pays his employees fairly.

TRACY
Where do I leave it?

JOHN
You can leave it on the desk, thank
you.

She approaches the desk and leaves the package down.

TRACY
Smells really good. What's in
there?

JOHN
Some pasta with meatballs and
gravy.

TRACY
Where is this place by the way? Is
it any good?

JOHN
It's near where I live. The best in
all Jersey.

TRACY
You go there often?

JOHN
I try not to.

TRACY
Well. I guess I'll go back to my
desk. Do you need anything else?

JOHN
Did you remember to call the nanny?

TRACY
Of course. She's going to pick her
up.

JOHN
Perfect. Thank you Tracy.

TRACY
You are welcome.

Tracy leaves the office. John goes back to his desk.

He sits down and carefully takes the package. He opens it
and inside he finds in fact pasta with meatballs and gravy.

Plastic cutlery is taped on the box's lid.

He strips it and, to his surprise, a printed phone number is
revealed beneath.

He immediately dials it and picks up the receiver.

INTERCUT: JOHN IN HIS OFFICE - SKINNY AT THE PAY PHONE.

EXT. GAS STATION - DAY

Skinny is smoking while sitting outside a gas station.
There's a pay phone a few feet away.

The pay phone next starts ringing. He puts out the cigarette and picks up.

JOHN
Hello?

SKINNY
It's Skinny.

JOHN
Everything okay?

SKINNY
He needs you to go see someone.

JOHN
When?

SKINNY
Today.

JOHN
Who is it?

SKINNY
An old friend.

JOHN
Do I get a name?

SKINNY
What for? The man's 78, you'll recognize him when you see him.

JOHN
Where do I find him?

SKINNY
He lives at the Four Season.

JOHN
He lives there? Is he-

SKINNY
Yeah. Everyday at 6.30 he comes down to the bar for a drink. Always sits at the same place, third one on the bar's right.

JOHN
Got it. What do I say?

SKINNY

Ask if he needs anything from De Santis, wait for his answer then leave and call back on this number. Don't say anything else.

John pauses for a moment, considering. Skinny looks into the receiver.

JOHN

I can't do that.

SKINNY

I'm sorry?

JOHN

It's too direct. It's too close. I can't.

SKINNY

That's not really an option you get Mr. Lewis.

JOHN

Is Tony there? Can I have a word with him?

Skinny brutally hangs up the phone.

JOHN (CONT'D)

Hello?

He puts down the phone.

JOHN (CONT'D)

Fuck.

I/E. JOHN'S HOUSE - NIGHT

John is on the doormat about to enter, he lingers a little. As he turns the doorknob we see on his watch that it's 6.30.

John enters the house and leaves his briefcase by the door. The lights in the kitchen are on, John heads towards it.

In the kitchen a woman with short dark hair is cutting something next to the sink. She has her back turned against the door entrance. We can hear the soft recoil of the music playing at maximum volume in her headphones. She's humming that same song we can kind of hear.

John approaches her, but it's clear she can't hear him. The scene becomes almost eerie as, from behind, we watch John slowly get closer and closer to this woman, who is oblivious to the fact that she's not alone anymore.

John reaches and puts his hands around her waist and leans his head on her right shoulder.

As she feels touched she is startled, but as soon as she realizes who's hands they are, she turns around and smiles at him. They kiss each other.

She's MARY.

Mary takes off her headphones.

JOHN

Hi B.

MARY

Hi sweetie.

They kiss again, then John moves to the fridge.

JOHN

How was your day?

MARY

Full. As always.

John opens the fridge and picks up some white wine.

MARY (CONT'D)

How about you?

JOHN

I don't know. Wine?

MARY

Yes please.

John moves to the cabinet and picks up two wine glasses while talking.

JOHN

We might have a good case.

MARY

Yeah?

JOHN

Yeah - This studio exec that,
according to him, was fired just
because he was sleeping with his
boss' mistress.

John pours the wine.

MARY

Juicy. Expect some TMZ.

John hands her one glass.

TOGETHER

Cheers.

JOHN

Well yeah, we'll see. What's going
on with you?

John comes over and sits on the kitchen counter in front of
her.

MARY

We may be getting somewhere.

JOHN

Really?

MARY

Really. One of them ditched
Richards.

John almost chocks on his drink.

JOHN

What?

MARY

Richards doesn't know yet, but the
guy asked to speak to some other
lawyer. Might be some tactic
though, haven't really looked into
it yet.

JOHN

What's the lawyer name?

MARY

Sarah Lynch. Ever heard of her?

John's eyes widen.

JOHN
I don't know. Sounds Irish.

MARY
Yeah. I guess it does.

John chugs the remaining wine.

MARY (CONT'D)
You okay?

JOHN
Yeah, absolutely.

JOHN (CONT'D)
Where's Grace?

MARY
In her room, doing her homework hopefully.

JOHN
Okay. I'm gonna go freshen up a little.

MARY
Sure thing. It's gonna be a while here probably.

JOHNJ
No problem.

John heads upstairs, Mary goes back to cooking.

INT. JOHN'S HOUSE - UPSTAIRS - CONTINUOUS

John doesn't turn on the lights as he heads for his room.

He stops in front of a room that has light inside, the voice of a child repeating some notions is heard.

He almost decides to go in, but can't bring himself to do it.

He keeps on walking in the dark until he reaches his bedroom door. He pushes it slowly.

INT. JOHN'S HOUSE - BEDROOM - CONTINUOUS

John and Mary's bedroom is really spacious and even in the dim night light we can see the tidiness of the room.

John walks around the bed and heads into the bathroom.

INT. JOHN'S HOUSE - BATHROOM - CONTINUOUS

John enters and locks the door behind himself.

He opens the tap then takes a deep breath.

He takes his phone out of his pocket and calls somebody.

JOHN
De Santis ditched him.

MALE VOICE
What?

JOHN
Hired Lynch.

MALE VOICE
He's really mad John.

JOHN
I don't know what to tell you
Chris. Just make sure he knows.

CHRIS
I will.

JOHN
Thanks. Gotta go.

John hangs up and puts the phone down by the sink.

He collects some water from the stream then throws it on his face.

He stares in his own eyes for a moment then reaches for his phone in order to delete his last call from the log.

He closes the tap and heads out of the bathroom.

INT. THERAPIST OFFICE - DAY

The office is very well lit, the furniture is very minimal. There's a desk a couple of armchairs divided by a glass coffee-table with a box of tissues on top.

John sits with his legs crossed on an armchair. He's looking at his nice leather shoes.

Right in front of him sits his therapist, CLARA PALMER, in her 40's, attractive.

CLARA
What's wrong? You seem troubled.

John turns his hollow eyes to her.

JOHN

Why would I be here otherwise?

CLARA

Therapy is not just about coming in
when something is causing turmoil
to your emotional life.

JOHN

What is it about then?

CLARA

Do you remember what you told me
the first time we met?

JOHN

Yes.

CLARA

How's that going?

JOHN

It's good. It's done. That's way I
haven't been coming in all that
much recently.

CLARA

I don't agree with that diagnosis.

JOHN

Of course you don't.

CLARA

I think it's getting worse and
worse and you refuse to come here
because you would have to admit to
yourself that it's becoming a
serious problem.

JOHN

And you got all that from what?

CLARA

From a text I got at three in the
morning saying you needed someone
to talk to.

(a beat)

What's going on John?

EXT. STREET - LATER

John walks out of the building where his therapist office is and heads to the right.

A MAN, leather jacket, mean looking, that was leaning on a car parked by the sidewalk starts walking behind John. John doesn't notice him.

The man picks up his pace and reaches John. He puts an hand on John's shoulder and stops him.

MAN
John Lewis right?

John worries immediately.

JOHN
Yes?

MAN
6.30. Four season. Don't be late,
he'll be expecting you.

John is caught by surprise. He has never seen this man before.

JOHN
What?

The man gives John a little amicable slap and heads in the opposite direction.

John is left petrified looking at him.

The man turns around one last time.

MAN
Don't be late. He doesn't like
late.

The man laughs then disappears in the crowd.